

APPENDIX A: PROJECT PRIORITIZATION



Appendix A – Project Prioritization Memo

Project prioritization is a standard exercise in transportation planning projects that grounds decision making in data and community input. It provides an objective assessment of potential projects, typically using a screening process and scoring criteria associated with a plan’s vision and goals and practical aspects that may affect the feasibility of a project such as jurisdictional purview, potential project costs, implementation timeline and the opportunity to leverage planned work or funding. While screening, scoring and prioritization process may evaluate an extensive list of potential projects, the goal of the exercise is to come down to a list of projects that could be planned and/or implemented over the anticipated timeframe of the plan.

Screening

The existing conditions analysis and holistic network map development identified over 100 potential pedestrian and bicycle infrastructure project opportunities across the city of Mountain View. The potential projects were initially screened to estimate the general scale and scope of project types (e.g., quick build or paint and post projects vs. corridor green street improvements) and categories of possible project types (e.g., pedestrian improvements, bicycle improvements, green streets). Projects were also screened to determine if the project was within the purview of the City’s responsibilities. The majority of potential projects were retained through the screening process.

Scoring

The MVATP scoring process used seventeen criteria distributed across four of the five guiding principles: Access and Equity, Safety and Comfort, Mobility and Connectivity, and Sustainability and Biodiversity. Each scoring criteria had an associated metric that allowed for measurement of the criteria using objective data, community comments or professional judgment (*Table 1: Mountain View Active Transportation Scoring Criteria*Table 1). Mountain View staff across several departments, the TAC, ATPAC and BPAC and CTC and City Council all provided input into the scoring and prioritization process.

Table 1: Mountain View Active Transportation Scoring Criteria

Guiding Principle	Scoring Criteria	Data source	Metric thresholds	Scoring
Access and Equity	Supports lower income residents	U.S. Census data	Project is not within a low- or low- to mid-income census tract	0
			Project is within a low- to mid-income census tract defined as having more than 14% of the population below 200% of the	7

Guiding Principle	Scoring Criteria	Data source	Metric thresholds	Scoring
			federal poverty level (FPL).	
			Project is within a low-income census tract defined as having more than 28% of the population below 200% of FPL.	14
Access and Equity	Fills a gap in existing sidewalk network	City of Mountain View GIS data	Project does not close a sidewalk gap	0
			Project partially closes a sidewalk gap	3
			Project does close a sidewalk gap	6.5
Access and Equity	Fills a gap in All Ages and Abilities (AAA) bicycle network	City of Mountain View GIS data	Project does not close a gap in the AAA bicycle network	0
			Project partially close a gap in the AAA bicycle network	3
			Project does close a gap in the AAA bicycle network	6.5
Maximum score for Access and Equity scoring criteria				27
Safety and Comfort	Addresses community concerns	GIS data representing an aggregation of community comments from Maptionnaire survey, walk audits, other community events, and Mountain View's online and 311 community comment portals	Project area has low density of community comments (lower third)	0
			Project area has medium density of community comments (middle third)	4
			Project area has high density of community comments (top third)	9

Guiding Principle	Scoring Criteria	Data source	Metric thresholds	Scoring
Safety and Comfort	Addresses existing (historic) crash patterns	GIS crash data analysis from Mountain View Local Road Safety Plan	Project area has no or low density of fatal or severe injury crashes (bottom third)	0
			Project area has medium density of fatal or severe injury crashes (middle third)	7
			Project area has a relatively high density of fatal or severe injury crashes (top third)	14
Safety and Comfort	Improves pedestrian network density	Mountain View GIS data measuring the distance between pedestrian crossing opportunities	Project does not reduce pedestrian block length at all	0
			Project reduces pedestrian block length but not to less than 500'	2
			Project reduces pedestrian block length to less than 500'	4
Safety and Comfort	Reduces pedestrian crossing distance	Mountain View GIS data measuring the width of pedestrian crossing distance at intersections	Project does not decrease width of pedestrian crossing distance	0
			Project does decrease width of pedestrian crossing distance	5
Maximum score for Safety and Comfort scoring criteria				32
Mobility and Connectivity	Supports school children	Mountain View GIS data of all school locations	Project is more than 5-minute walk (0.25 mile) from a school (public or private)	0
			Project is less than 5-minute walk (0.25 mile) from a school or on a suggested route to school (public or private)	4
			Project fronts a school (public or private)	9

Guiding Principle	Scoring Criteria	Data source	Metric thresholds	Scoring
Mobility and Connectivity	Supports other key destinations (commercial center, park, trail, senior center or senior living community)	Mountain View GIS data of key destinations	Project is more than 5-minute walk (0.25 mile) from a key destination	0
			Project is less than 5-minute walk (0.25 mile) from a key destination	4
			Project fronts a key destination	9
Mobility and Connectivity	Improves first/last mile connection to transit	Mountain View GIS data of all transit stops	Project is not within 5-minute walk (0.25 mile) of any transit stop (bus or rail)	0
			Project is within 5-minute walk (0.25 mile) of any transit stop (bus or rail)	2
			Project is within 10-minute walk (0.5 mile) of major transit stop or high-quality transit corridor (bus or rail)	4
Maximum score for Mobility and Connectivity scoring criteria				22
Sustainability and Biodiversity	Reduces impervious surface area	Mountain View satellite imagery and GIS data	Project does not reduce impervious surface area	0
			Project reduces impervious surface area by less than 4%	2
			Project reduces impervious surface area by 4% or more	4.5
Sustainability and Biodiversity	Provide Plantable Space	Mountain View satellite imagery and GIS data	Project does not increase open space for plantings (per typical)	0
			Project provides enough space for ground cover plantings (plantable spaces < 5' wide)	2

Guiding Principle	Scoring Criteria	Data source	Metric thresholds	Scoring
			Project provides enough space for ground cover plantings and shade trees (plantable spaces ≥ 5' wide)	4.5
Maximum score for Sustainability and Biodiversity scoring criteria				9
Feasibility	Order Of Magnitude Cost (includes environmental, ROW, etc.)	Previous Mountain View project unit costs	\$\$\$ (> \$10M)	0
			\$\$ (\$2M - \$10M)	1
			\$ (< \$2M)	2
Feasibility	Interagency Coordination	Assessment of agency jurisdictions and departmental responsibilities	City and 2 or more additional outside agencies	0
			City and 1 additional outside agency	1
			None, only city departments	2
Feasibility	Practical Implementation Timeframe	Mountain View staff professional judgment	Long	0
			Medium	1
			Short	2
Feasibility	Opportunity To Leverage Existing Planned Project	Mountain View staff professional judgment	No	0
			Yes	2
Feasibility	Alignment With Local, Regional And/or Federal Funding Sources/Opportunities	Mountain View staff and consultant professional judgement	No	0
			Yes	2
Maximum score for Feasibility scoring criteria				10
Total maximum scoring across all scoring criteria				100

The screened potential projects were scored based on the degree to which the anticipated improvements met each scoring criteria's metric threshold. A maximum score of 100 was possible; potential project scores ranged from a high of 88.5 to a low of 7.

Prioritizing

City staff reviewed the twenty-four highest scoring potential projects and selected twenty to move forward into draft project concepts (the four other projects already have plans underway or are in the Caltrans right of way).